

The Ferdinand Times

VOL. 1 — FRIDAY, OCTOBER 9, 2026 — MEXICO CITY — AS OF 5:55 A.M. CT

YOUR DAY

Three Friday plans are live today – SpaceXAI at 10, Buildathon at 5, GDG at 7 – and none is on Google Calendar

Calendar still lists Swim, Miami, and Discovery. Luma reminded overnight. Rain through the day, heavier tonight.



Ferdinand, the three off-calendar plans are no longer “tomorrow.” Luma wrote late last night that Grok Bot CDMX con SpaceXAI is today at 10:00 a.m. at HAAB Project in Condesa – Ricardo Garcia and Marcos Zavala speak, Hassan from SpaceXAI is a guest, and registered attendees get credits. Bring a laptop for Grok Bot and Cursor. A second Luma note said the Reap x AIBM Agentic Buildathon starts today, 5:00–9:00 p.m. at Sandbox Hub. GDG CDMX’s AI codelab is still listed for 7:00 p.m. Google Calendar has none of the three; it still shows Food, Miami, and Discovery in those hours.

Overnight mail also flagged a Codex review on just-a-clipper-engine pull request #33 (“fix: accept setup failures in MCP status”). Hetzner reported a failed credit-card charge yesterday afternoon – still open, no new overnight note. Cursor’s payment thread is quiet after earlier declines this week, which means it is still unresolved. Weekend calendar is mostly Sleep; the weekday skeleton returns Monday, and Checkpoint day is Tuesday evening.

TODAY

6:30–8:30 A.M.	Swim After News / catchup at 6:00; light rain ~15°C at the pool	CALENDAR
10:15 A.M.	Food Second Food block at 3:00 p.m.; SpaceXAI meetup is off-calendar at 10:00	CALENDAR
4:00–6:30 P.M.	Miami Overlaps Buildathon start at 5:00 if you go to Sandbox Hub	CALENDAR
6:30–10:00 P.M.	Discovery Overlaps Buildathon and GDG 7:00; Journaling at 10:00, Sleep at 11:00	CALENDAR

THIS WEEK

SAT–SUN – Sleep is the main calendar entry; weekday skeleton returns Mon Oct 12 (News, Swim, Food, Miami, Discovery, Journaling).
TUE OCT 14 – Checkpoint day, 10:00 p.m.–midnight, overlaps Journaling.
TONIGHT OFF-CALENDAR – Buildathon 5–9 at Sandbox Hub; GDG AI codelab at 7:00; ALMAS debut set in Condesa at 8:00 (On the Town).

TONIGHT

Buildathon 5–9 and GDG at 7 sit on top of Miami and Discovery. If you stay in Condesa after the meetup: ALMAS plays Fvck Off Room at 8:00. See On the Town.

WEATHER

18° / 14° HIGH / LOW

About 15°C with a light rain shower at compile, feels like 14°C, humidity 92%. Light rain this morning, patchy rain this afternoon, then moderate rain this evening (near 88% by 9:00 p.m.). Pack the umbrella for Condesa and any evening hop.

SAT	Light rain showers much of the day	22° / 15°
SUN	Cloudy; heavy rain in the evening	24° / 14°

NEEDS A LOOK

LUMA / SPACEXAI	ACTION
Today 10:00 a.m., HAAB Condesa. Laptop + credits for registered attendees. Still off calendar.	
LUMA / BUILDATHON	ACTION
Today 5:00–9:00 p.m., Sandbox Hub. Ticket held; not on Google Calendar.	
HETZNER	ACTION
Credit-card charge failed yesterday afternoon. Invoice notice still open.	
CURSOR BILLING	ACTION
No new decline overnight. Still unresolved from earlier this week.	
PR #33 CODEX	FYI
just-a-clipper-engine: review on “fix: accept setup failures in MCP status.”	

DUE

Add SpaceXAI and Buildathon to today’s calendar; pick one evening room; fix Hetzner and Cursor cards; skim PR #33 when you have a minute.

INBOX

EVERY

Why We Handed Our Agent's Infrastructure to Anthropic

BY PARIDHI AGARWAL · EVERY · THURSDAY, OCTOBER 8

Every Agent launched October 6 on Claude Managed Agents. Agarwal explains why the team left a self-hosted OpenClaw fleet – and which trade-offs they accepted.

On a Friday in September, Arielle Shipper's salad went missing from the office fridge. Douglas Brundage did what most of us at Every now do with a problem. He asked @Every in Slack.

"who stole Arielle's salad!?! make a list of likely culprits"

A minute later it posted a ranked list of suspects, starting with the people it knew had been in the kitchen that afternoon. After every named employee had made their case, @Every zeroed in on Leo, the office dog: Everyone else needed a motive. He only needed an unattended bowl. Nobody found the salad.

Over the past five months, we've been building a coworker that lives in your Slack, keeps up with what's happening around the office, and joins in when someone asks it to investigate a missing lunch. That's Every Agent, which we launched on October 6. In Slack it goes by @Every.

Every Agent runs on Claude Managed Agents (CMA), a service Anthropic launched in April. It runs the machinery an agent needs to think, remember, and pick up where it left off. That let a small team spend its time on the parts you see in Slack.

We didn't know any of this when we started. We didn't set out to build one agent for the whole company, nor did we plan to hand its machinery to someone else to run.



EDITOR'S SUMMARY: Agarwal goes on to explain that Plus One – personal OpenClaw agents on rented VMs – turned into high-maintenance pets, not cattle. The team moved to one shared company agent, tried self-hosting, then rebuilt on Claude Managed Agents in May so engineers could work on Slack coworker behavior instead of harness upkeep. Trade-offs they accepted: deploy-race bugs when shipping mid-task, Opus 5 verbosity (later eased on 5.5), cache costs on long DMs, Claude-only lock-in, and no zero-data-retention path. The goal is a coworker you'd miss if it were gone – Leo remains the lead suspect on the salad.

THE PRAGMATIC ENGINEER

The Pulse: Firebase's global outage & poor response

BY GERGELY OROSZ · FREE BONUS · THURSDAY, OCTOBER 8

A backend config cleanup crashed iOS apps using Firebase Analytics for hours. The status page stayed green; the community found the root cause first.

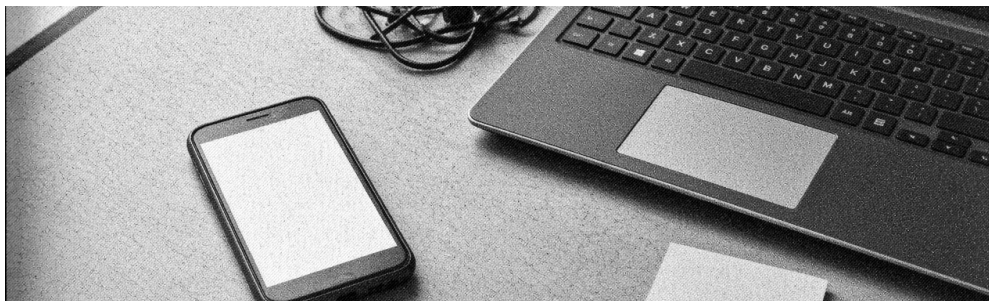
Firebase – built by Google – has had a nasty outage this week with shockingly poor incident management at odds with how Google itself usually deals with high-severity incidents.

The outage started on Tuesday (29 Sep) at 5:41pm (PDT), when iOS apps using the Firebase SDK started to crash upon first opening; every iOS app that uses the Firebase SDK with analytics enabled was affected in this way. Developers of affected apps opened a GitHub ticket, in the absence of much else to do.

6:51pm (PDT): acknowledgement. An hour and ten minutes after the crashes started, an engineer on the Firebase team acknowledged that they were aware of the outage.

Others attempted to help the Firebase team by pinpointing the potential issue. Indeed, before a Google engineer acknowledged the incident, an external developer found the root cause at 6:37pm PDT; it was a zero-length entry that was crashing the SDK.

7:24pm (PDT): rollback starting. An hour-and-a-half into the incident, the Firebase team started rolling back the offending backend change. The rollback completed about fifty minutes later – though cached bad payloads kept some apps crashing longer.



EDITOR'S SUMMARY: Orosz then reports that Firebase never marked the outage on its status page, which stayed green because dashboards watch server health, not client SDK crashes. Google published a post-mortem on October 2: a routine legacy-flag cleanup shipped a malformed payload; the iOS SDK failed to validate a nil flag name. Android did not crash the same way. He compares the episode to the 2020 Facebook SDK crash and argues public incident hygiene still matters for developer platforms – even when AI is speeding up other work.

INBOX

BYTEBYTEGO

How Software Boundaries Are The Most Important Skill for Developers

FROM BYTEBYTEGO · THURSDAY, OCTOBER 8

The email opens on why dividing a system well is a craft – then hits the paywall. Printed from what arrived in inbox only.

No matter how big a software system gets, it will still have a boundary. This boundary separates things inside the system from those outside it. In fact, you'd have noticed that dividing a large system into multiple components can have some great benefits. However, deciding how the system should be divided requires skill and understanding. Experience is the best teacher in such cases. But there are also some strategies that can help.

But what exactly does a boundary do?

A good software boundary keeps an application's responsibilities, its rules, and the details needed to apply those rules together. Parts of the system outside this boundary can talk to things inside the boundary only through a clear pathway.

This means that the skill of deciding boundaries requires you to have an idea of which responsibilities should be bunched together. Also, which dependencies should exist between them.

In this article, we'll learn some key strategies that can help a developer make the right boundary-related decisions for the systems they are working on.

The rest of the issue sits behind ByteByteGo's paywall in email. Full strategies continue on the web for subscribers.

TLDR

SpaceX spectrum for towers, a touch-screen MacBook in late October, and Claude Code Mods

FROM TLDR · FRIDAY, OCTOBER 9

This morning's Big Tech and Programming briefs – amounts omitted.

SPACEX MOBILE

SpaceX is buying U.S. cellular spectrum licenses in the 800-megahertz band, meant for tower coverage rather than satellites, to fill places satellite links cannot reach. Some terrestrial infrastructure is still required.

TOUCH-SCREEN MACBOOK

Apple is expected to introduce a touch-screen MacBook and a new iPad mini on or around October 27, with an online video and an in-person press component. A separate home-hub event is also on the calendar for next week.

CLAUDE CODE MODS

Mods are plugins that change how Claude Code looks and behaves – panes, commands, and tool-call rules that can redraw the interface and step into tool calls in ways hooks and MCP alone cannot.

EDITOR'S SUMMARY: Also in today's issue: Bootstrap 6 alpha (Sass modules, ESM-only JS, modern CSS; Bootstrap 5 still supported), Amazon Leo's 1,000th satellite with commercial broadband targeted by year-end, and Atomic Machines' AI-assisted microrobot manufacturing push. Money figures from the spectrum item are omitted here.

THE TOWN

RECOMMENDED

Claude Code Mods – first look

TLDR flags Mods as plugins that add panes, commands, and tool-call rules inside Claude Code itself. They can redraw the UI and intercept tool calls in ways hooks, skills, and MCP servers cannot. A practical try before tonight's agent-heavy rooms.

Linear: stacked pull requests

Linear's Oct 8 changelog highlights stacked pull requests – a workflow for stacking dependent changes instead of one oversized branch. Useful context while PR #33 sits in review on clipper-engine.

ON THE TOWN



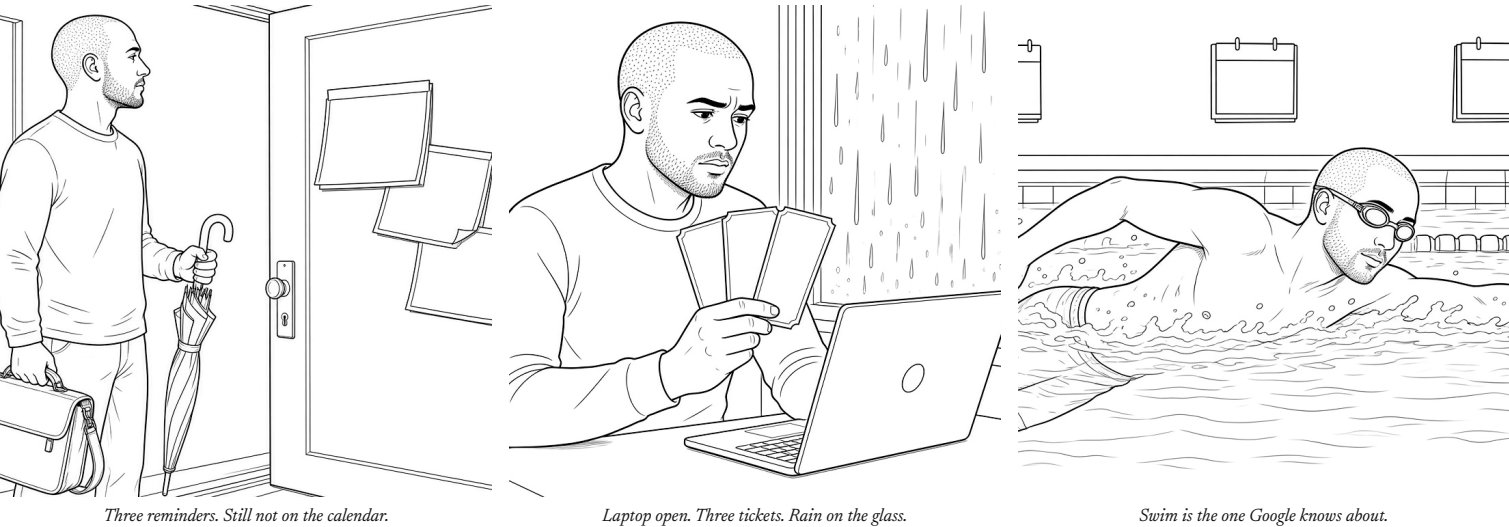
ALMAS – METANOIA, tonight 8 p.m., Fvck Off Room

The group plays its debut full-length album live in Hipódromo Condesa, 8:00 p.m. to midnight – first concert as a band for the record.

Gala Williams Vol. II – Sat Oct 10, Teatro Ángela Peralta

Live John Williams film scores in Polanco, 6:00–8:30 p.m.: Star Wars, Jurassic Park, and the rest of the catalog that still fills theaters when the brass stands up.

PUZZLES



MINI CROSSWORD

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9

ACROSS

1 Vapor off a rainy morning swim

6 Brief, as last night's Luma notes

7 Wipe Miami before the Buildathon, maybe

8 The laptop SpaceXAI asked you to bring

9 What Grok Bot CDMX does at 10 a.m.

DOWN

1 Kettle output before News / catchup

2 Curt, like those Cursor decline mails

3 Clear Discovery if GDG wins the evening

4 Useful thing registered attendees carry in

5 Gets together – three times on today's fringe

STEAM · VAPOR · ERASE · TERSE · ASSET · MEETS

DEAR TIMES

SpaceXAI said bring a laptop for credits. Do I open it during the talks or keep it shut?

Dear Times, The meetup mail says bring a laptop for Grok Bot and Cursor, and registered people get credits. If I open the machine while Ricardo and Marcos are talking, I look like I'm somewhere else. If I keep it shut, I carried it across Condesa in the rain for a closed lid. What's the move?

– Laptop in Condesa

Dear Laptop, Open it when the session is hands-on; shut it when someone is mid-story. Credits are for registered attendees, not for a glowing screen during Q&A. Sit near power, lid closed for the talks, then use the machine when they invite demos. The rain already did enough work for one morning.

– The Times

JUMBLE

Unscramble each word. Circled answer boxes spell the bonus: what three wet Friday plans demand (4 letters).

ROKSG

YNARI

WSMIS

TNEGA

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GROKS RAINY SWIMS AGENT · GRIT

WANTED

Calendar slots that accept Luma.

Three approved Friday events seek empty rows on Google Calendar. Currently occupied by Miami and Discovery, who were not on the guest list.

One payment method, two vendors.

Hetzner and Cursor both seeking a card that completes a charge. Silence overnight does not count as success.

FOR SALE

Personal agent fleet, high maintenance.

OpenClaw pets on rented VMs. Prefer one shared coworker on managed infrastructure. Heal-bot manuals included.

Status page, permanently green.

Survived a client-side SDK outage without changing color. Collectors of optimistic dashboards only.

NOTICES

Municipal weather desk

~15°C and raining at swim time; high near 18°C; moderate rain likely by evening. Saturday stays showery; Sunday clouds then heavy rain after dark.

Department of Stacked PRs

Linear shipped stacked pull requests. clipper-engine #33 awaits Codex notes under the new grammar of small dependent diffs.

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